

# **GUDK – Göta Studentkår**

## **Memorandum of understanding**

**[5<sup>th</sup> September]**

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Under this Memorandum of Understanding, the University of Gothenburg Doctoral Student Union (from now on referred as GUDK) and Göta Studentkår come together to agree on the principles guiding the relation and collaboration between the two organizations after GUDK's transition into an autonomous student union.

The partners agree to respect each other, their members and their representative positions now and in the future, **and guarantee noninterference and non-intervention into the matters of the other organization.** (We will not be partaking in matters of the other union.)

## 1 Background

1.1 GUDK and Göta studentkår want to establish a first contact to cooperate in the monitoring, development and improvement of students' wellbeing, social environment and education across the faculties of activity for *Faculty of Humanities, Faculty of Education, Faculty of Science and Technology, Faculty of Social Sciences* at the University of Gothenburg (GU).

1.2 It is an equal collaboration for the mutual benefit of all students in the organizations and across the university.

1.3 The establishment of GUDK as an independent student union for doctoral students at GU has necessitated the restructuring of its prior organizational framework. GUDK operated until July 1<sup>st</sup> as an advisory body under the auspices of GUS, maintaining only an indirect association with the faculty PhD councils, which functioned as subdivisions of the four original student unions of GU –namely, HHGS, Göta studentkår, Konstkåren and SAKS. The formation of GUDK as an autonomous student union entails the formal transfer of these faculty PhD councils to GUDK. Upon the attainment of official student union status, effective July 1<sup>st</sup> 2025, GUDK will assume the mandate to represent doctoral students across the university, while the original four student unions shall retain their respective authority over the

representation of undergraduate and master's students. Therefore, in recognition of these structural modifications and the corresponding reassignment of roles and responsibilities, it is deemed necessary to establish formal channels of communication and to negotiate and initial agreement governing the collaboration and mutual support between GUDK and the four original student unions.

## **2 Description of Organizations**

2.1 GUDK is an independent non-profit organization that aims to monitor, develop and improve third-cycle education at GU. Its aim and purpose is to represent all third-cycle students at GU, across all faculties. It will be start functioning as fully distinct and autonomous student union from July 1<sup>st</sup> 2025.

2.2 Göta studentkår is a democratically run non-profit association of students at the University of Gothenburg. Göta studentkår is religiously, ideologically and party-politically unbound. The aim of Göta studentkår is to protect, promote and monitor the interests of its represented students in educational and study social issues.

## **3 Cooperation aims and objectives**

3.1 The primary purpose of the cooperation between the two organizations is to facilitate mutual support in overseeing and enhancing the quality of education and well-being of the students they represent, as well as the broader student body at GU.

3.2 The Organizations agree:

3.2.1 To establish and maintain communication on all matters about the education, well-being, and social development of students at all represented faculties. A particular emphasis will be placed on faculty-

level interactions, where closer and more direct collaboration between the organizations will be needed;

3.2.1.1 To maintain a closer relationship, the two organizations agree to share pertinent information with each other, even when one of the organizations may not have a formal representation position in that specific committee.

3.2.2 To meet annually or as needed to go over this document to adjust for timely necessities and keep the two organization boards updated.

## **4 On responsibilities and representatives**

4.1 The two organizations agree on the current division of responsibilities and of representative roles at department and faculty levels of GU as existing prior to GUDK becoming a student union.

4.2 Each organization shall respect the decisions in these matters.

4.3 Should either organization judge that a correction in the division of representatives and cooperation is necessary, such concerns shall be addressed through good-faith dialogue and negotiation at the faculty level. Any modifications to the representation structure shall be done with the goal of maintaining a fair and balanced presence of both organizations while keeping in mind the best interest of students they represent.

4.4 Should either organization leave vacant any of their representative positions (i.e., GUDK or Göta studentkår fails to elect a representative for a committee or council), the other organization may, to the best of their capacities and interest, share information, minutes and details of the discussions of that committee or council with the other

organization until that vacant position is filled. The vacant position shall not be occupied by the other organization if left vacant.

## **4.C Sharing of responsibilities with Social Sciences Section at the Faculty of Social Sciences**

4.C.A Social Sciences Section (from now on Samsek) and GUDK would share representative positions between them as a sharing of responsibility.

4.C.B Despite sharing the representative positions, Samsek and GUDK will continue to share pertinent information with each other in good faith.

4.C.C Representatives from Göta studentkår and representatives from GUDK would review this section annually or as needed to stay updated and informed.

4.C.D The division of responsibilities and representation look like this:

### **4.C.D.1 At the faculty level:**

4.C.D.1.1 Samhällsvetenskapliga fakultetsstyrelsen (SFS) – 1 representative from GUDK, 2 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.1.2 Lärarförslagsnämnden (LFN) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.1.3 Arbetsutskottet (AU) – 1 representative from GUDK, 2 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.1.4 Prefektråd – 1 representative from GUDK, 2 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.1.5 Lokal- och arbetsmiljökommittéen (LAMK) – 1  
representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.1.6. Beredningsgrupp för forskning (BFF) – 2 representatives  
from GUDK

4.C.D.1.7 Dekans beslutsmöte – 1 representative from GUDK, 1  
representative from Göta

4.C.D.1.8 Lokalkommittén – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.1.9 Mijöråd – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.1.10 Beredningsgruppen för utbildning på grund- och  
avancerad nivå – 2 representatives from Göta

#### 4.C.D.2 **At School of Public Administration:**

4.C.D.2.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 co-opted representative from  
GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.2.2 Arbesmiljögruppen (AMG) – 1 co-opted representative  
from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.2.3 Rådet för forskning och forskarutbildning (RFF) – 1 co-  
opted representative from GUDK

4.C.D.2.4 Utbildningsrådet (UR) – 1 co-opted representative from  
GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.2.5 Beslutsmöte med prefekt – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.2.6 Miljö- och hållbarhetsgruppen – 1 representative from  
GUDK

#### 4.C.D.3 **At School of Global Studies:**

4.C.D.3.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.2 Lokal arbetsmiljögrupp (ALG) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.3 Forskarutbildningsnämnden för ESS (FUN) – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.3.4 Utbildningsrådet (UR) – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.5 Utbildningskommittén – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.6 Programråd Globala Studier – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.7 Programråd Antropologi – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.8 Programråd Internationella Relationer – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.9 Programråd Master i Globala Studier – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.3.10 Programråd Master Human Rights – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.4 **At Department of Political Science:**

4.C.D.4.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.4.2 Beslutsmöte med proprefekt – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta



4.C.D.4.3 Lokal arbetsmiljögrupp (ALG) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.4.4 Handledarkollegiet (HK) – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.4.5 Programråd statsvetenskap – 13 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.4.6 Programråd Master Political Science – 4 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.4.7 Programråd Master Political science: environmental Governance and Behavior – 4 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.4.8 Programnämnd för Europakunskap – 5 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.4.9 Programråd master International Administration and Global Governance – 1 representative from Göta

#### 4.C.D.5 **At Department of Social Work:**

4.C.D.5.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.5.2 Forskarutbildningskommittén (FUK) – 2 representatives from GUDK

4.C.D.5.3 Arbetsmiljögruppen (ALG)– 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.5.4 Hållbarhetsrådet – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.5.5 Nationella forskarskolan i socialt arbete – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.5.6 Utbildningskommitté Socionomprogrammet – 2  
representatives from Göta

4.C.D.5.7 Utbildningskommitté Avancerad nivå – 2  
representatives from Göta

**4.C.D.6 At Department of Journalism, Media and  
Communication:**

4.C.D.6.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.6.2 Doktorandforum (DSC) – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.6.3 Handedarkollegiet (HALK) – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.6.4 Arbetsmiljögruppen (ALG) – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.6.5 Studentråd – 6 representatives from Göta

**4.C.D.7 At Department of Sociology and Work Science:**

4.C.D.7.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 representative from Göta, 1  
representative from GUDK

4.C.D.7.2 Arbetsmiljögruppen (AMG) – 1 representative from Göta, 1  
representative from GUDK

4.C.D.7.3 Beredningsgruppen för forskning och forskarutbildning  
(BFF) – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.7.4 Programnämnd Personalvetarprogrammet – 3  
representatives from Göta

4.C.D.7.5 Programråd arbetsvetarprogrammet – 1 representative  
from Göta

4.C.D.7.6 Programnämnd Master Programme in Strategic Human Resource Management and Labour Relations – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.7.7 Beslutsmöte med prefekt – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.7.8 Kursplaneringsgruppen – 1 representative from Göta

**4.C.D.8 At Department of Psychology:**

4.C.D.8.1 Institutionrådet (IR) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.8.2 Forskarutbildningsberedningen (FUB) – 1 representative from GUDK

4.C.D.8.3 arbetsmiljögruppen (AMG) – 1 representative from GUDK, 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.8.4 Programnämnden för Psykoterapeutprogrammet – 3 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.8.5 Beredningsgruppen för Psykologprogrammet – 3 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.8.6 Beredningsgruppen för Fristående kurser, Grund- och Avancerad nivå – 3 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.8.7 Beredningsgruppen för Master i Psykologisk Vetenskap – 2 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.8.8 Beredningsgruppen för Extern Utvärdering Masterprogrammet – 1 representative from Göta

4.C.D.8.9 Beredningsgruppen för Kliniken – 2 representatives from Göta

4.C.D.8.10 Grundutbildnings beredningsgruppen – 2 representatives from Göta

We, the undersigned have read and agree with this section of the MOU.

## 5 Disclaimer

5.1 It should be noted that, by signing this document and/or cooperating, the two organizations are not committing to legally binding obligations. The organizations remain independent of each other. Their collaboration and use of the term 'partner' does not constitute the creation of a legal entity, nor are they legally committed to each other unless a legally binding agreement regulates so.

We, the undersigned have read and agree with this MOU.

### Signed on behalf of **GUDK**

*Sanskriti Chattopadhyay*

.....  
Sanskriti Chattopadhyay, Chairperson

2025-09-05

Date .....

### Signed on behalf of **SamSek**

*Olivia Bergström*

.....  
..... Olivia Bergström, Section chairperson

Date 2025-09-08

## Signed on behalf of Göta Studentkår

*Moa Clasberg*

.....  
*Moa Clasberg, Chairperson*

2025-09-08

Date .....

*Linn Andén*

.....  
*Linn Andén, Vice chairperson*

2025-09-08

Date .....

# Verifikat

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## Dokument

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